FoSCoS — Instant Temporary License Flow: Complete Specification

What This Is

The Instant Temporary License (ITL) is a fast-track FSSAI pathway for small, low-risk food operators — street vendors, home kitchens, tiffin services, food carts — who need to start operating legally within minutes, not weeks. It costs ₹0, issues instantly, lasts 60 days, and carries a legal obligation to upgrade to a permanent license before it expires.

This document covers everything: every entry point, every screen, every branching rule, all backend logic, and the post-issuance lifecycle.

Entry Points — How a User Gets Into This Flow

There are **three distinct entry points**, and they matter because they determine how much pre-screening has already happened.

Entry Point A: Direct ("Instant Temporary License" card on homepage)

The user clicks the "Apply for Temporary License" service card on the home screen. This routes them straight to `tl-s1` — the Eligibility screen — with no prior context collected. This is the primary and cleanest entry path.

Entry Point B: Via the Turnover Calculator in the Permanent License Flow

A user enters the permanent license flow (business setup → food items → turnover calculator). If their calculated annual turnover comes out under ₹10 lakh, the system flags them as eligible for the temporary track and surfaces a hint panel: *"You qualify for an Instant Temporary License — ₹0 fee, issued today."* The button on that hint sends them into the temp flow. Critically, the data they've already entered (food categories, turnover) should carry forward — the user should not have to re-answer questions they've already answered. In the current prototype, this carryover is not implemented; it's a known gap.

Entry Point C: Via the FBO Gateway Popup

From the home screen, if a user clicks "Hi, I'm new here," a gateway popup appears. This popup presents both license types. If they select the temporary track from here, they go to

`tl-s1`. Same as Entry Point A, but with slightly more context about who the user is (they've self-identified as new).

Flow Architecture Overview

The flow has **8 numbered steps** with a progress bar visible throughout:

Step 1: Eligibility Check
Step 2: Mobile OTP / Authentication
Step 3: Personal + Business Details
Step 4: Document Upload
Step 5: Food Items & Restrictions
Step 6: Operating Rules & T&C
Step 7: License Issued
Step 8: Post-License — Compliance Window & Next Steps

There is also a **Purpose Screen** (`tl-purpose`) that sits between Step 1 (eligibility result) and Step 2 (OTP). This screen asks whether the user is setting up for a stall/event or a permanent business. This answer governs the license validity (30 days vs. 60 days) and the entire post-issuance experience.

Screen-by-Screen Breakdown

PRE-FLOW: Eligibility Screening (`tl-s1`)

What it is: A lightweight, three-question screener that determines whether the user qualifies for the temporary track before they invest time filling out the application.

The three questions:

Q1 — Setup Type (single select) Options: Street Vendor, Food Cart, Small Stall, Home Kitchen, Cloud Kitchen, Tiffin Service, Juice Stall, Other. The user picks one. This sets `TLData.bizType`. The "Other" option surfaces a free-text field.

Q2 — Annual Turnover Estimate (single select) Options: Under ₹12 Lakh/year, ₹12 Lakh – ₹1.5 Crore, ₹1.5 Crore+. This is a simplified version of the permanent license turnover calculator. The user is picking a bracket, not entering exact figures.

Q3 — Food Items (multi-select chips) Options: Packaged Snacks, Tea/Coffee, Roasted Items, Bakery (no cream), Fruits & Vegetables, Cooked Meals, Meat/Fish, Dairy Products, Sweets/Mithai, Fresh Juices. The user can pick multiple.

The Eligibility Decision Logic:

When the user hits "Check My Eligibility," the system runs two checks:

IF turnover bracket = "₹12 Lakh – ₹1.5 Crore" OR "₹1.5 Crore+"
→ INELIGIBLE: "Your turnover exceeds ₹12 Lakh/year. You need a State or Central FSSAI License."
→ CTA: "Apply for Correct License →" (routes to permanent flow)

ELSE IF selected foods include 'meat' OR 'dairy'
→ INELIGIBLE: "Selling raw meat or unpasteurised dairy requires a higher-category license."
→ CTA: "Apply for Correct License →"

ELSE
→ ELIGIBLE
→ Show success modal with "Continue →" to Purpose Screen

The result is shown in a modal overlay on the same screen. No new screen loads.

Data stored: `_tlEligSetup`, `_tlEligTurnover`, `_tlEligFoods` (these are separate variables from `TLData` — the carryover into the main flow is a current gap in the prototype).

PURPOSE SCREEN (`tl-purpose`)

What it is: A two-option screen that determines the nature of the business, which controls license validity duration and the post-issuance dashboard state.

Options:

- 🛖 **Stall / Event (1 Month):** For festivals, events, one-time occasions. Validity = 30 days. No obligation to upgrade.
- 🏪 **Permanent Business Setup (2 Months):** For someone setting up a real food business who needs a bridge license while they gather documents for permanent registration. Validity = 60 days. Legal obligation to upgrade within the window.

Backend impact: The selection sets a flag (`tlPurpose = 'stall'` or `'business'`) that is read at Step 7 to determine:

1. How many days appear on the license card
2. Which post-issuance dashboard state loads (Step 8)
3. Whether a countdown timer and next-steps panel are shown

STEP 2: Mobile OTP / Authentication (`tl-s2`)

What it is: Phone number entry + OTP verification. This is the authentication step, not just a contact collection step — it creates or looks up the user's FoSCoS account.

Flow:

1. User enters 10-digit mobile number
2. Clicks "Send OTP" → system calls MSG91 (or equivalent) to dispatch a 6-digit OTP
3. Six OTP input boxes appear. Auto-advances focus between boxes.
4. On completing all 6 digits, auto-triggers verification after 350ms delay
5. On success: icon changes to ✅, title shows "Verified!", then navigates to Step 3 after 900ms

Edge cases to handle:

- Invalid number (fewer than 10 digits) → alert before sending OTP
- Resend OTP link appears after send
- If the user already has an account with this number, the backend should recognize it and pre-fill their details on Step 3 (not currently implemented in prototype)

Data stored: `TLData.phone`

STEP 3: Personal + Business Details (`tl-s3`)

What it is: The core identity and business registration screen.

Fields collected:

Field	Type	Required	Notes
Full Name	Text	Yes	Person in charge
Mobile Number	Tel	Yes	Pre-filled from Step 2, editable
Area / District of Operation	Text	Yes	Free text (to be replaced with pincode auto-detect per brief)

Business Name	Text	Yes	The trade name that appears on the license
Setup Type (confirmation)	Display	Auto	Should be auto-filled from eligibility screen selection, not re-asked

Current gaps in prototype:

- The "Area" field is free text — the brief specifies replacing this with a pincode field that auto-detects area
- Business name is present in `tl-s3` HTML but `TLData` doesn't have a dedicated `businessName` field — it gets pulled via `document.getElementById('tl-name').value` which is the person's name, not the business name. This is a data model inconsistency.
- The setup type (vendor/cart/stall etc.) was already selected on the eligibility screen but is asked again here as a clickable card grid — redundancy to eliminate

Validation:

- Name: non-empty
- Mobile: 10 digits, numeric only
- Area: non-empty (until pincode is implemented)

STEP 4: Document Upload (`tl-s4`)

What it is: Minimal KYC — only 2 documents required, compared to the permanent license's much larger document checklist.

Required documents:

Document 1 — Photo Identity Proof Accepted: Aadhaar, PAN, Driving Licence, Voter ID, Passport. A clear phone photo is acceptable. The interface shows an AI scan confirmation ("✅ AI Scan: Identity verified") after upload — this is currently simulated with a 1.8-second timeout.

Document 2 — Proof of Establishment User must upload one of: Cart/Stall Purchase Bill, Rent Agreement, or Electricity Bill. This proves the physical existence of the business location.

Upload interaction: Each document row is collapsible (click header to expand). After upload, the row gets a green "done" state, the step number turns to ✓, and the progress bar updates. When both documents are uploaded (2/2), the Continue button activates.

Backend expectations:

- Files should go to S3/R2 with a path keyed to the user's phone number and application ID
- The "AI scan" confirmation should eventually be a real OCR/verification step — Aadhaar OCR to extract name and number for cross-check

Data stored: `TLData.docs = {id: bool, addr: bool}` (note: field is named 'addr' but it's actually proof of establishment — naming inconsistency)

STEP 5: Food Items & Restrictions (`tl-s5`)

What it is: The user selects what they plan to sell. Unlike the eligibility screen chips, this is the formal declaration for the license. Items are color-coded by risk.

Food item cards:

Food Item	Risk Level	Hover/Select Color
Packaged Snacks	Allowed	Green
Tea / Coffee	Allowed	Green
Roasted Items	Allowed	Green
Bakery (no cream)	Allowed	Green
Fruits & Vegetables	Allowed	Green
Cooked Meals	Allowed	Green
Fresh Juices	Allowed	Green
Sweets / Mithai	Allowed	Green
Meat / Fish	Restricted	Red
Dairy Products	Restricted	Red

The restriction logic: If the user selects any restricted item (meat or dairy), an ineligibility banner appears immediately and the "Continue" button hides. The banner says they need a different license. The "Continue" button only appears when zero restricted items are selected.

This is a hard gate — you cannot proceed through the temp license flow with restricted food items selected. The user must either deselect those items or use the link to apply for the correct license.

Data stored: `TLData.foods[]` (array of food IDs), `TLData.hasRestricted` (boolean)

STEP 6: Operating Rules & T&C (`tl-s6`)

What it is: A mandatory acknowledgement screen. The user must check all four boxes before the license issuance button activates.

The four operating restrictions displayed:

1. **Maximum Area: 500 sq. ft.** — Kitchen or stall must not exceed 500 sq. ft. of food preparation area.
2. **Gas Stove Only — No Industrial Equipment** — Commercial deep fryers, blast chillers, industrial cooking units not permitted.
3. **Low-Risk Foods Only** — No raw meat, unpasteurised dairy, or cold-chain products.
4. **Valid for 60 Days Only** — Must complete compliance and upgrade within 60 days or cease operations.

The four checkboxes the user must tick:

1. "I have read and understood the restricted operating rules listed above."
2. "I agree that FSSAI officers may conduct an unannounced inspection of my premises."
3. "I will complete FoSTaC food safety training and apply for a permanent license within the validity period."
4. "All information I have provided is true and accurate to the best of my knowledge."

Button state: The "Get My Temporary License →" button starts disabled and greyed (`opacity: 0.45`). It becomes active only when all four checkboxes are checked. This is enforced client-side via `tlCheckTC()`.

STEP 7: License Issued (`tl-s7`)

What it is: The license issuance screen. There are two sub-states on this screen: an "issuing" animation, followed by the license card display.

The issuance animation sequence: The system runs through four steps with 600ms intervals, displayed as status text:

1. "Verifying geo-tag…"
2. "Checking documents…"
3. "Assigning license number…"
4. "Issuing certificate…"

After the animation completes, the issuing state hides and the license card appears.

What the license card shows:

- License number: generated as `TL-2026-[AREA]-[6-digit-random]` (e.g., `TL-2026-SHI-394821`)
- Holder name + location: pulled from `TLData.name` + `TLData.address`
- Business type: mapped from `TLData.bizType` to human-readable (e.g., `vendor → "Street Vendor"`)
- Date issued: today's date
- Date of expiry: today + 60 days (calculated in JS)
- Active status badge (green pill)

Post-issuance actions on this screen:

- Download License (PDF — currently simulated with a 3-second button state change)
- Share on WhatsApp
- "View My License" → goes to `my-tl-screen` (the temp license dashboard view)
- "Back to Home"

The branching by purpose: The `tlSetFinalState()` function checks which purpose was selected (stall vs. business) and updates the license card's validity display and which next-steps section appears:

```
IF purpose = 'stall'
  → Show: "License valid for 30 days. Enjoy your event!"
  → Hide: next-steps wrap (no upgrade path shown)
  → Show: stall-end note

IF purpose = 'business'
  → Show: "Valid until [date 60 days out]. You have 2 months to complete compliance."
  → Show: next-steps wrap (with upgrade guidance)
  → Show: 60-day countdown timer
```

STEP 8: Post-License Compliance Window (`tl-s8`)

What it is: The "what now" screen that appears after license issuance for business-purpose applicants. It presents three tabs explaining what the user needs to do within 60 days.

Three tabs:

Tab 1 — Water Test Report The user needs to get their water source tested. This tab explains the requirement and links to the Water Testing service in One Stop Shop.

Tab 2 — FoSTaC Training FoSTaC (Food Safety Training and Certification) is mandatory. This tab explains the training, its cost, duration, and has an "Enroll Now" button. When clicked, the button triggers `tlEnrollFostac()` — a simulated enrollment with 1.4s delay after which the button disappears and a "Enrolled ✅" confirmation appears. This advances the progress bar to step 6.

Tab 3 — Officer Inspection Explains that an FSSAI officer may visit unannounced. Lists what to have ready: original documents, clean kitchen, food items matching the license.

The countdown timer: A large number displaying days remaining (`tl-days-remain`, initialized to 60) and the expiry date. In the current prototype this is static — it needs to be dynamic, calculated from the issuance timestamp stored in the database.

The My Temp License Dashboard (`my-tl-screen`): A separate full-screen view accessible from the main FBO dashboard that shows: the license card in a dark themed card, status (ACTIVE), days remaining, compliance progress, food restrictions reminder, and links to the three compliance tasks.

Backend Data Model (Inferred)

Here is what the backend needs to store per temporary license application:

```
TempLicenseApplication {
  id              : uuid (primary key)
  applicationId     : string (e.g. "TL-2026-SHI-394821")
  userId            : FK → Users
  phone             : string
  name              : string
  businessName      : string
  bizType           : enum (vendor|cart|stall|home|cloud|tiffin|juice|other)
  area              : string
  address           : string
  purpose           : enum (stall|business)

  turnoverBracket   : enum (under12|12to150|above150)

  foodItems         : string[] (array of food IDs)
  hasRestricted     : boolean
```

```
  docIdPath         : string (S3/R2 URL)
  docEstabPath      : string (S3/R2 URL)

  status            : enum (active|expired|upgraded|cancelled)
  issuedAt          : timestamp
  expiresAt         : timestamp (issuedAt + 30 or 60 days)

  fostacEnrolled    : boolean
  waterTestDone     : boolean
  inspectionDone    : boolean

  upgradedToAppId   : FK → PermanentLicenseApplication (nullable)

  createdAt         : timestamp
  updatedAt         : timestamp
}
```

Eligibility Rules — Consolidated

Rule	Threshold	Result
Turnover	Under ₹12 Lakh/year	Eligible
Turnover	₹12 Lakh+	Ineligible → redirect to permanent flow
Food items	No meat or dairy	Eligible
Food items	Meat or dairy selected	Ineligible → redirect to permanent flow
Setup area	Max 500 sq. ft.	Declared via T&C acceptance
Equipment	Gas stove only	Declared via T&C acceptance

License Validity Rules

Purpose	Validity	Post-issuance obligation
Stall / Event	30 days	None (it expires and that's it)

Permanent Business Setup	60 days	Must complete FoSTaC + water test + apply for permanent license

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Known Gaps in the Current Prototype (for your roadmap)

1. **No payment screen in the temp flow** — The brief explicitly calls this out. Currently, the temp license is ₹0 so no payment page was built. If you add any fee in future, this needs to be inserted between Step 6 and Step 7.
2. **Eligibility data doesn't carry into TLData** — The three eligibility questions (Q1/Q2/Q3 on `tl-s1`) write to separate variables (`_tlEligSetup`, `_tlEligTurnover`, `_tlEligFoods`), but `TLData.bizType` is re-selected on Step 3. The eligibility screen selection should pre-populate the Step 3 selection.
3. **Back button is broken** — The brief notes this. `tlGo(-1, step)` navigation is inconsistent throughout the new flow.
4. **Purpose screen is sandwiched oddly** — It sits between the eligibility result modal (on `tl-s1`) and Step 2 (OTP). In the redesigned flow per the brief, the purpose screen should come before the eligibility check, not after.
5. **No real geo-tagging** — The "Verifying geo-tag…" in the issuance animation is purely cosmetic. GPS coordinates should be captured during document upload or at a dedicated step.
6. **Countdown timer is static** — The 60-day timer needs to read from a real `issuedAt` timestamp.
7. **FoSTaC enrollment is simulated** — The enroll button fakes a 1.4s delay. This needs a real integration with the FoSTaC training portal or an internal enrollment system.
8. **Business name field inconsistency** — `tl-s3` collects "Full Name" (person) but the license card uses `tl-name` as the holder, mixing person name and business name.
9. **The old temp flow (`temp-kyc-screen`, `fostac-quiz-screen`, `temp-license-screen`) still exists** — There are two parallel temp license implementations in the file. The old one routes through `temp-kyc-screen` (3 KYC docs) → FoSTaC quiz → license. The new one is the 8-step `tl-s*` flow. Both exist in the DOM. The old flow should be deprecated.